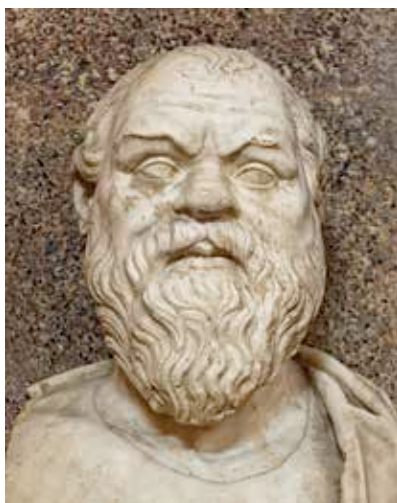


stand” and “The more I understand, the less I know”. In the context of this story, I’d like to borrow from those to say “the more we know the less I know”. Obviously, “we” is our species, and “I” is just us as individuals, and most importantly, this is me speaking for myself, and not you, so please feel free to disagree.

With The Borg, the individual is called a Drone, and is really an expendable and unimportant part of a collective. A tool, that is used to achieve something, but is not to be mourned if lost. With 7.5 billion people on the planet, and especially for us as Indians, it sometimes feels like we’re headed in that direction, doesn’t it? We already feel nothing for the poor individuals we hear about on a daily basis, dying or suffering in various ways, because how much can one person really care? If we were distraught at every death or suffering we ever heard of, we’d spend our lives in abject misery, just crying our eyes out. Becoming



I know that I know nothing – Socrates

colder to the suffering of others is our own defense mechanism kicking in, and self preserving. It’s certainly not something we can ever say is wrong or something we should be ashamed of, but we should recognise its existence.

The reason I raise this is not because I fancy myself as a philosopher,

but because being ignorant and cold and unfeeling as an individual, yet smart as a collective, which is capable of self preservation of the species and yet being ruthless to other species is the very definition of ____.

You fill in that blank. Seems to me, both “the Borg” and “humans” seems to fit there as a valid answer, doesn’t it?

HAVE WE BEEN ASSIMILATED?

I’ve laid out the case for why I think we have, but it’s up to you to decide whether we have or we haven’t. I think we still have a long way to go before we get there, and I’m hoping that our humanity and emotions will keep pricking us and keep bringing us back from the brink of becoming truly grey, cold and unthinking drones like the Borg. More than anything else, I hope I am proven utterly and completely wrong in the future, and I think there is a very real chance that I will be, because resistance is not futile... not yet. 

THE REAL CYBERNETICS

Bodyhacking, implants, and the promise of a truly hybrid human-machine existence

Robert Sovereign-Smith | editor@digit.in

Now that Agent 001 has given you his take on why we are already cyborgs, or rather, as he has corrected me in the past, The Borg, it’s time to look at some real cyborgs, and some real cybernetics that are not something that’s far away in the distant future of humanity, but in fact, very much avail-

able today, and might well be mainstream technology in under a decade!

Every single trend has always had the early adopters. As early adopters of cutting-edge consumer technology, all of you are aware of this, because you go out and buy the latest phone or gadget way before they become popular or mainstream, or be involved

in some geek culture before it was normal. I’m sure most Marvel comics fans feel like that now, because while the movies have made the Marvel universe open out to the masses, the comics were a staple for so many comic book geeks for decades now! I can’t even imagine how irritated they must be when people who just discovered the